

changeling identity, and therefore it's important to understand his place in Kithain society and his perspective on his magical existence. While a prelude session may cover some of this territory, it's usually best to begin at the Chrysalis. What event caused his Chrysalis? Was it traumatic, transcendent, or maybe a bit of both? Did anyone guide him into changeling society, or did he somehow find his own way there? What were his first impressions of Kithain life? When did he first encounter the nobility and changeling politics, and how does he feel about it?

Assuming your character isn't coming into the chronicle entirely new to Kithain life, she probably has some role or niche to occupy in the changeling community. What does she contribute to Kithain society? Is she well known to local changelings? If so, what's she known for? Does she deserve her reputation? Who's her local liege, and how does she feel about their rule? If she is a noble, what are her obligations and ruling style? If she's a commoner, is she politically minded or does she accept the status quo? Does she attend large changeling gatherings and festivals, or does she mostly keep to herself apart from seeing her motley? Has she sworn any oaths? Visited the Far or Deep Dreaming? Does she view her new existence as a blessing, a curse, or a puzzle to be figured out?

Appearance

Along with establishing her identity, it's important to get an idea of what your character looks like in order to communicate her image to the Storyteller and the other players, as well as to better visualize the events taking place in the story. Changelings are unique in that they have both a mortal seeming and a fae mien to describe.

The mortal guise is what all mundane beings perceive, including Prodigals, unless they possess a special sense or affinity for the fae. A changeling's guise often hints at elements of her fae seeming, though she still appears to be a normal, if possible quirky or eccentric, human being. A sluagh's guise is usually pale and on the thinner side, for instance, while a redcap's is often stocky and menacing. Pooka often have features that recall elements of their animal selves, such as a badger with white streaks in his hair, while nockers tend toward colorful language and a slightly disheveled look.

In addition, some chimerical items and treasures have mundane guises as well — a mighty chimerical blade might look like a humble wooden sword to mortal eyes. Describing the guise and any items carried is important because it affects how mortals react when they encounter the changeling; a police officer is going to react very differently to what he perceives as man waving a wooden sword compared to someone wielding a real one, or seemingly carrying nothing at all.

A changeling's fae mien, by contrast, is a chance for players to get really creative. So long as you respect the boundaries of your character's Traits — a character with a low Appearance

rating can't be described as flawlessly beautiful and alluring — a changeling's fae mien is a place for you to run wild creatively. The Kithain are fantastical beings brought to life, after all. The Storyteller has the final say on what is acceptable for a character's fae mien, but is encouraged to allow a healthy amount of leeway provided that elements of the character's appearance are understood to be purely cosmetic, and cannot replace or augment actual game mechanics.

With that in mind, take some time and really dig into an interesting and fantastic appearance for your character. A sidhe doesn't just have bright red hair, she has shimmering hair that flickers and shifts like a roaring fire in a hearth. A troll's skin is marbled like granite and always feels a little cool to the touch, like a rock face in the shade. A sluagh's shadow sometimes moves when it thinks no one is looking, glancing side to side as if watching out for someone. A nocker's clothing whizzes and clicks, sometimes making its own alterations or little repairs as if guided by unseen mechanisms. A changeling who's mastered Summer magic seems to always have just a hint of the scent of freshly-cut grass and ice-cold lemonade lingering around her.

So long as the Storyteller approves, your fae mien description is a place to really make her unique and memorable. Don't forget to describe her voile, or chimerical clothing, as well as any significant treasures or chimerical items she's carrying (and if they have mundane counterparts). A changeling who appears to be wearing casual street clothes in his guise but is decked out in a full suit of plate armor forged from magical stained glass is going to make a statement, after all, especially if he normally appears in noble finery.

If an item has game statistics attached to it, such as weapons, armor, or magical treasures, this is the time to record those mechanics. Bear in mind that beyond clothes and very basic necessities, unless she also has the appropriate Backgrounds to possess them — Resources for mundane items, Chimera for chimerical ones, or Treasure for items with magical properties — your character may not be allowed to own certain items, subject to the Storyteller's approval.

Quirks

Although these sometimes arise naturally during play, quirks can certainly be devised during character creation as well. Essentially, quirks are little gestures and mannerisms a character displays that make her distinctive and express her personality. A quirk does not have to be something grand or particularly eccentric; if your character is constantly chewing gum or has a habit of humming show tunes, that's just as memorable as a character who insists on referring to himself in the third person or who is always wearing ludicrous hats. Good quirks are not about simply displaying strange or irritating behavior for its own sake; they are representations of a character's habits and personality traits.